

Leave Policy

Policy ID: HR-LV-01 · Version: 2025.1 · Effective: 1 January 2025 · Owner: People Operations

Company: Nilebyte Solutions (fictional company, dummy data for a portfolio project)

1. Scope

1.1 This policy applies to all full-time and part-time employees. Contractors and interns follow the leave terms in their individual agreements.

1.2 Part-time employees receive leave entitlements pro-rated to their contracted hours. For example, an employee contracted at 50% of full-time hours receives 50% of the full-time entitlement.

1.3 "Working day" means a day that is not a weekend day (Friday or Saturday) and not a company public holiday.

2. Annual Leave

2.1 Entitlement. Full-time employees receive 21 working days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Employees with 10 or more years of continuous service receive 25 working days per calendar year.

2.2 Accrual. Annual leave accrues monthly at a rate of 1.75 days per month of service. Employees who join or leave during the year receive a pro-rated entitlement.

2.3 Probation. Employees may not take annual leave during their first 3 months of employment (the probation period), although leave continues to accrue during this time. Exceptions require written approval from the HR Business Partner.

2.4 Notice. Requests for 3 or fewer consecutive working days must be submitted at least 3 working days before the first day of leave. Requests for more than 3 consecutive working days must be submitted at least 2 weeks before the first day of leave.

2.5 Approval. All annual leave must be approved by the employee's direct manager in the HR system. A request is not confirmed until it has been approved.

2.6 Carryover. Up to 10 unused annual leave days may be carried over into the next calendar year. Carried-over days must be used by 30 June of that year, after which they expire. Unused days above the carryover limit are forfeited and are not paid out, except on leaving the company (see 2.8).

2.7 Blackout periods. Employees in the Finance department may not take annual leave during the last 5 working days of a fiscal quarter without approval from the Finance Director. Fiscal quarters end on 31 March, 30 June, 30 September and 31 December.

2.8 Payout on exit. When an employee leaves the company, accrued but unused annual leave for the current calendar year is paid out at the employee's base daily rate.

3. Sick Leave

3.1 Employees receive 10 working days of paid sick leave per calendar year. Unused sick leave does not carry over.

3.2 Employees must notify their manager before the start of their working day, or as soon as reasonably possible.

3.3 A medical certificate is required for sick leave of more than 2 consecutive working days.

3.4 Sick leave beyond the 10 paid days is treated as unpaid leave. Long absences may be covered by the long-term disability benefit described in the Benefits Policy, section 4.

4. Parental Leave

4.1 Primary caregivers receive 12 weeks of fully paid parental leave following the birth or adoption of a child.

4.2 Secondary caregivers receive 3 weeks of fully paid parental leave, to be taken within 6 months of the birth or adoption.

4.3 Employees become eligible for parental leave after 6 months of continuous employment.

4.4 Employees should notify HR at least 8 weeks before the expected start of parental leave, where possible.

5. Other Leave Types

5.1 Bereavement leave. Employees receive up to 5 paid working days following the death of an immediate family member (spouse, partner, child, parent or sibling) and up to 2 paid working days for other relatives.

5.2 Marriage leave. Employees receive 3 paid working days for their own marriage, once during their employment.

5.3 Exam leave. There is no separate exam leave. Employees who sit exams for a professional certification use annual leave.

5.4 Unpaid leave. Employees may request up to 30 calendar days of unpaid leave per calendar year. Unpaid leave requires approval from both the direct manager and HR.

5.5 Civic duties. Paid leave is granted for jury service or other legally required civic duties for the required duration, on presentation of an official summons.

6. Public Holidays

6.1 The company observes the public holidays published each year in the HR system. If a public holiday falls within an approved annual leave period, that day is not deducted from the employee's annual leave balance.

6.2 Employees who are required to work on a public holiday receive a replacement day off, which must be taken within 30 days.

7. Contacts

7.1 Questions about this policy should be sent to People Operations at hr@nilebyte.example.